

NIST

NIST is the National Institute of Standards and Technology, an American non-regulatory agency. It has been in existence since 1901, initially as the National Bureau of Standards. It was renamed to NIST in 1988. Its mission is to "*promote U.S. innovation and industrial competitiveness by advancing measurement science, standards, and technology in ways that enhance economic security and improve our quality of life.*" (NIST, 2018).

It contributes to security standards in many ways but the most relevant ones are the Computer Security Research Centre (CSRC) Special/ Security Publications (SP-800-xx), its cybersecurity framework and its work in FIPs certification (which we will discuss later in this unit).

The Cybersecurity framework was initiated by President Obama in 2013. Version 1.1 was released in 2018 after several conferences and requests for comments being issued. The compliance council (Allport, 2018) has a good comparison between the NIST framework and ISO 27001 on its blog.

[Here the video shows how the framework is composed by the terms “recover”, “identify”, “protect”, “detect” and “respond”.]

The Federal Information Processing Standards (FIPS) are another set of standards and publications managed and produced by NIST.

According to the website "*FIPS publications are intended for use by federal government agencies to protect non-national security federal information systems. FIPS publications do not apply to national security systems. FIPS publications may be adopted and used by non-federal government organizations and private sector organizations.*"

The current FIPS publications can be found at FIPS (2018). Many devices that use cryptographic keys adhere to the FIPS 140-2 standard for cryptographic modules.